

TIANZHOU YAO

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Seattle, WA - 98105, United States

EDUCATION

- **M.A. and Ph.D. Economics** 2019 - 2026 (expected)
University of Washington
- **B.A. Quantitative Economics & Finance** 2015 - 2019
Jinhe Center for Economic Research, Xi'an Jiaotong University

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Macroeconomics, Applied Microeconomics, Public Finance, Labor, Family Economics

WORKING PAPER

[Intra-household Bargaining, Endogenous Divorce, and Female Labor Supply \[JMP\]](#)

This paper examines the effects of intra-household bargaining and endogenous divorce on female labor force participation over the life cycle. I develop a structural life-cycle model incorporating household heterogeneity in education, non-labor income, and female bargaining power. Calibrated to Japanese survey data, I extend the model to incorporate social norms influencing the gender division of housework and the career penalties associated with motherhood due to increasing returns to experience. I apply this framework to evaluate the impact of alternative taxation systems on household labor supply and welfare.

Presentations: American Economic Association 2026 (scheduled, poster), Gender in the Economy: Structural Transformation and Women's Time-Use 2026 (submitted), UW Department of Economics "Macro-Timeseries-International" Brownbag 2023-2025

PUBLISHED PAPER

[Financial Literacy Confidence and Retirement Planning: Evidence from China \(Research Assistant for Bingzheng Chen and Ze Chen\)](#)

In this paper, we conduct a survey to examine how individual's financial literacy confidence bias affects their retirement planning behaviors in China. The survey measures both the respondent's subjective and objective financial literacy, as well as their assessment and actual actions with respect to their retirement planning. We find that financial literacy overconfidence (under-confidence) significantly promotes (demotes) individual's retirement planning behaviors. Our results contribute to understanding the effect of subjective financial literacy on retirement planning.

Published: Risks (2/2023)

Presentations: UW Department of Economics Labor and Development Brownbag (2022), Tsinghua University SEM (2019)

WORK IN PROGRESS

Increasing Return to Experience, Social Norm, and Female Labor Supply

I extend my structural framework of Job Market Paper to incorporate human capital accumulation and increasing returns to experience. Combined with social norms on wife's share of child care, the structural life-cycle model will be able to rediscover motherhood penalty under a new light.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

- **Research Project: Prediction of RMB Exchange Rate from Policy Changes** 3/2019-5/2019
for Professor Wen-Jen Tsay, Academia Sinica, Taiwan
 - Prediction of RMB exchange rate from monetary policy changes using ARIMA and Markov-switching models.
 - Macroeconomic controls (like CPI) were introduced, adopted VAR model for factor analysis.
- **Research Assistant: Econometric Analysis of Water Resources and Economic Development** 1/2018-7/2018
for Professor Yuan Zhao, Jinhe Center for Economic Research
 - Applied Difference in Difference on self compiled panel data to analyze the effect of chronological patterns of water management policies.
 - Showed that a combination of centralized and decentralized water management structure could address the trade-off between scarcity of water resources and consumption.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

- **Instructor, University of Washington** Winter 22, Spring 22, Summer 22, Winter 23, Spring 23
ECON 300 Intermediate Microeconomics
◦ Average evaluation: 4.4/5
- **Instructor, University of Washington** Autumn 22
ECON 301 Intermediate Macroeconomics
◦ Average evaluation: 4.4/5
- **Instructor, University of Washington** Autumn 21
ECON 200 Introduction to Microeconomics
◦ Average evaluation: 3.3/5
- **Teaching Assistant, Foster School of Business, University of Washington** Autumn 25
QMETH 501 (MBA) Decision Support Models
- **Teaching Assistant, Foster School of Business, University of Washington** Autumn 23, Summer 24–Spring 25
QMETH 201 Introduction to Statistical Methods
- **Teaching Assistant, Foster School of Business, University of Washington** Spring 24
FIN 460 (Undergraduate), FIN 560 (MBA) Investments

CONFERENCES & DISCUSSIONS

- **Gender in the Economy: Structural Transformation and Women's Time-Use** March 2026
 - **The Allied Social Science Associations Meeting*** January 2026
 - **Opportunity & Inclusive Growth Institute's Annual Research Conference[†]** October 2024
- *denotes presentation, [†]denotes discussions*

AWARDS

- UW Economics Department PhD Program Fellowship 2019
- Research Excellence Award for Undergraduate Thesis 2019

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

- **Boston Consulting Group** 2025
Bridge to BCG
- **Edgeworth Economics** 2023
PhD Summer Symposium
- **McKinsey & Company** 2019
Intern
- **PwC** 2018
Intern
- **French Reinsurance Company** 2017
Intern

SKILLS

Programming: STATA, R, Matlab, $\LaTeX$

REFERENCES

Professor Fabio Ghironi (committee chair)
Department of Economics
University of Washington
fabio.ghironi.1@gmail.com

Professor Stephen Turnovsky
Department of Economics
University of Washington
sturn@uw.edu

Professor Rachel Heath
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Professor Stephan Siegel (GSR)
Professor of Finance and Business Economics
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